Placement Policy 2025-26

1. Types of Companies

1.1 Category 1 Company:

A Category 1 company is a company that must meet at least one of the following conditions:

- ➢ Features in the Fortune Global 500, Fortune India 100, GPTW 100, Fortune GPTW 100, or GPTW Global 25 lists.
- ➢ Is a Unicorn or appears in the Sector Wise Top 10 list.
- ➢ It is recognized as a marquee or Day 0 organization.
- ➢ Is in patronage with the CDO.
- ➢ It offers a CTC higher than the average of the sector in the previous placement cycle.

Offer Policy for Category-1

- If a candidate receives a placement from a Category 1 company, they are out of the placement cycle due to the **one offer policy**.

1.2 Category 2 Companies:

A Category 2 company is any organization that does not meet the criteria for Category 1 and will automatically be classified as Category 2.

Offer Policy for Category-2

- If a student receives a placement offer from a Category 2 organization (as communicated by the Career Development Office or Placement Committee), they

become eligible for **four (4)** additional placement attempts. These four attempts can be used in two ways:

- **Ongoing Processes:** Applying to companies for which the student had already submitted applications before receiving the Category 2 offer.
- **Future Processes:** Applying to companies whose Job Descriptions (JDs) are released on Superset after the Category 2 offer is received, or saving attempts for yet-to-come companies. In the latter case, it will be called an "undecided" attempt.

- If a student wishes to avail 4 additional attempts, they must notify the CDO and PlaceCom of their decision within **24 hours** of receiving the Category 2 offer.

- This must be done via email and include a **200-word cover note** explaining why they wish to continue participating in the placement process or target specific companies.

Failure to comply within the 24-hour window will result in forfeiture of all remaining attempts.

- Students may choose to hold back a certain number of their four additional attempts as **"undecided"** for use with future companies, as mentioned above. However, when a student decides to apply to a company they had previously tagged as "undecided" in a 200-word cover note, they must immediately inform both the CDO and the designated PlaceCom PoC.

Failure to notify will result in the automatic withdrawal of the application.

- A student who has received a Category 2 offer may hold a **maximum of two offers**:
  - The initial Category 2 offer.
  - The **first** offer received from the four additional attempts (regardless of the company category or timing) will be considered the **final offer,** and the student shall lose the initial offer.

1.3 Dream attempt/company:

CDO will define certain organizations as “dream” based on brand, relationship, and CTC. All the students enrolled in the placement cycle will get one attempt to apply for the dream company.*

Offer Policy for Dream Company

- Maximum 2 offers, irrespective of the number of attempts
- In case a student exercises the dream option and converts it, the second offer will be their default choice, and the first offer will automatically be considered rejected.

* Students’ eligibility is up to CDO’s discretion. Students who reject an offer are not eligible for a dream attempt.

2. Pre-placement Talks (PPT)

- A pre-placement talk is conducted by the company participating in the placement process.
- It generally includes a detailed presentation that provides applicants with an overview of the company, its policies, hierarchy, recruitment process, career growth, job location, positions, and salaries offered.
- This is a two-way discussion, where students are encouraged to clarify their doubts or discuss anything related to the company or the profile.
- It is ***mandatory*** to attend the PPT (with videos on) of the company you are applying to; non-attendance may lead to a penalty (check 7.5). If applications for a company open *after* the PPT, only students who have attended the PPT will be eligible to apply.
- PPT generally happens before applications close, so that students can understand the company; however, sometimes, it is also conducted after the applications are closed. In such cases, students get to withdraw their application within a given period if they want to (check 3.2).
- Students need to attend for at least **80%** of the entire duration of the workshop/ discussions / PPT, etc., to be marked present.
- For virtual events like PPTs, all students are required to keep their camera on, and all queries/comments during the PPTs must be professional and respectful.
- All questions to recruiters outside of the PPT must be routed through the CDO/ PlaceCom, and direct communication with recruiters should be done only after written approval from the CDO/ PlaceCom, or else a penalty applies (check 7.5).
- Any query regarding the CTC breakup/compensation structure should be clarified in the PPT (or relayed through the PlaceCom Coordinator in case no PPT is scheduled) at the time of application submission.

3. Submission and Withdrawal of Application

3.1 Submission of Application

- A student who is still in the placement process is allowed to apply for all the jobs that come on campus, both social and corporate. Unless the job profile posted on Superset states otherwise (according to the recruiter's preference).
- All resumes that are submitted for applications must be ***strictly a one-page Ashoka resume format***. Resumes not in line with the guidelines will be rejected before being sent to the recruiter.
- All applications are promptly shared with recruiters, and requests for deadline extensions won't be considered. Some applications might be more detailed, so kindly plan and apply accordingly.
- Carefully read the entirety of the Job Description and other details (shared via Superset, email, or during PPT) regarding the job application. Mandatory requirements for successful completion of applications can be communicated via any of these channels, and if they are missed, your application will be removed from the applicant list.
- In case of any doubts, please direct all queries to the **company's PlaceCom Coordinator** before applying to avoid any misinterpretations.

3.2 Withdrawal of Application

No application may be withdrawn after the deadline for application submission has passed. However, there are a few exceptions:

- Withdrawal of the application from Superset will be **permitted for companies** that **conduct a PPT after the closing of applications**. Students can withdraw their application until 30 minutes after the PPT has been delivered. If the PPT is for the shortlisted candidates only, they may not be allowed to withdraw their application.

- If **any changes occur in the job description** due to a change in the organization's recruitment needs, the candidates will be **able to withdraw** their application mid-way **without incurring any penalty**/start afresh.

In any other case, if you decide to withdraw from the placement process or withdraw after closing of applications, you must contact the PlaceCom POC for the company, and, if required, the CDO.

4. Interview Round Guidelines

4.1 General Guidelines for Interview

Aspect	Guideline
Non-Attendance	If the student qualifies through to the interview round and does not attend it, it will lead to a heavy penalty (check 7.5).
Late Arrival	Late Arrival is treated as non-attendance. Students are expected to be prepared at least 15 minutes before their scheduled interview slot
Dress Code	Students must wear ***business formal*** attire only during all processes.

4.2 Final Interviews on Day Zero:

- Students shortlisted for the final round of interviews, which will be occurring on Day Zero, will be receiving further instructions from the PlaceCom and the CDO regarding logistical details such as time slots, venue details, among others.

4.3 Multiple Offers Policy during Day Zero:

- Students shortlisted for multiple organizations will receive a Preference List (form to indicate their preference for the organizations shortlisted).
- Students will be required to submit their preferences before the final interviews, and the timeline will be communicated by PlaceCom and CDO accordingly.
- If an offer is received from more than one organization (for students being shortlisted for multiple organizations for final interviews), the final offer will be processed as per the preference of the student, indicated in the preference list.

5. Final Offer and CTC Negotiation

CDO follows a **No-Rejection Policy**, meaning that once a student receives an offer, it is **automatically accepted**. The policy applies to both **Category-1** and **Category-2** companies, with the following guidelines:

5.1 For Category-1 Companies

- Once a student receives an offer from a Category-1 company, they are **blocked** from participating in the rest of the placement cycle.
- However, students are allowed to attempt a **Dream Company** interview even after receiving a Category-1 offer.
    - If selected by the Dream Company, the **Dream Offer will replace the Category-1 offer**, which is then considered rejected.

5.2 For Category-2 Companies

- An offer from a Category-2 company is also **automatically accepted**.
- After this, the student is allowed **up to 4 additional attempts**.
    - If the student receives a new offer during any of these attempts, the **previous Category-2 offer is automatically rejected**, and the **new offer is accepted**.
    - Only the **first offer received out of the 4 attempts** will be considered for replacement.

Reiterating that a student can receive a **maximum of 2 offers** throughout the placement cycle as described above.

5.3 Exception to No-Rejection Policy after Offer

- If a company **modifies its CTC** from what was originally communicated during the PPT/ in the JD, the student is allowed to reject the offer w/o any penalty.

6. Miscellaneous Rules

6.1 Pre-Placement Offer (PPO)

- A PPO will be considered as a job offer through campus placements:
- Accepting a PPO is indicative of the student being considered as per Categories 1 and 2 of the Placement Policy, and next steps will be communicated accordingly.
- Declining a PPO would be considered on a case-by-case basis, where the reasons would be carefully evaluated by the CDO/ PlaceCom before reaching a decision.
- The CDO shall always be kept in the loop in all official communication with the company's Point of Contact. This applies even in cases of direct communication with the recruiter.

6.2 Higher Education Plans

- In case of higher education plans, SGOs (Self-Generated Offers), you are expected to have complete transparency before, during, and after the interview. You must inform the CDO in advance about the same.
- The student needs to inform CDO about their higher education plan every time they apply to a new company.

6.3 Semester Abroad

- If a student is attending a Semester abroad, CDO will request the recruiter to accommodate the student however, the decision lies solely with the recruiter.
- The student needs to inform CDO about their semester abroad plans every time they apply to a new company.

6.4 Lying/Exaggerating/Misrepresenting information

- If a student is found to be fabricating information, faking achievements, exaggerating facts, and indulging in other such dishonesty on their resume, cover letters, and interviews, they will be **blocked for the entire placement cycle**.

- The PlaceCom/CDO may also conduct randomized fact checks at various stages of the Placement process.

6.5 Communication & Resources

- Keeping the students' interest in mind, the CDO will be sending out Superset undertakings/surveys from time to time. Students should promptly fill these out to communicate their interest in the campus placements and ensure they enroll in the placement cycle.
- Students are encouraged to seek guidance from the CDO and access the placement preparation resources/workshops being offered by the CDO and Placement Committee (PlaceCom). You can check out PlaceCom MasterDrive here.

6.6 Policy Violations

Policy violation	Penalty
The resume is not in the Ashoka format, or it doesn't follow the standard guidelines	Not eligible to sit in the CDO processes
Lying, Exaggerating, and/or Misrepresenting the information	Blocked for the entire placement cycle
Non-Attendance - PPT	10 Days block
Non-Attendance/Participation/Late Arrival /Late Submission In the first Interview/ Test/ Assignment	15 Days block
Misconduct with Ashoka staff/ recruiters*	20 - 30 Days Block

7. Deferred Placement Policy

This policy aims to support Ashoka University graduates who aspire to become entrepreneurs by offering a safety net in case their venture fails or if they choose to leave their startup venture. All graduates are eligible for this policy if they become entrepreneurs. They can avail support under this policy for a **maximum of 2 years from their graduation date**.

- Final-year students can choose to opt out of the placement process for that year by participating in the 'deferred placement program'.
- The decision to join the deferred placement program must be made **before the beginning of the Day Zero** placement process.
- The deferred placement program is exclusively available to graduating students who become entrepreneurs by starting their own venture or joining a startup as a co-founder.
- Graduating students need to provide proof of their startup.
- If a graduate, after opting for the deferred placement policy and starting their own venture, decides to discontinue their association with the startup, they can approach the CDO to be included in the next placement cycle.
- This option is available to the graduate after one year of the date of graduation and for up to 2 years.
- The graduate must provide proof of their dissociation from the startup if they wish to sit in the placement process.

Some More Important Resources

- Placement History & Company Data:

  Past company data is available here Past Recruiters Data & Analysis.

- MasterDrive (One-Stop Solution)

  A centralised repository of all official placement documents, policies, templates, and support material. Here is the link to MasterDrive: Master Resource Drive 2025

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q: Can I make changes to my profile after it has been verified?
A: Yes, you can make changes. However, **you must send a new verification request each time** you update your profile.

Q: How do I send a verification request again (2nd time or more)?
A: Use **Duperset** every time you need to send a verification request.

Q: What is Duperset?
A: Duperset is a tool developed by the **PlaceCom Projects team** to streamline and manage the profile verification process efficiently. Check it out here

Q: How long does profile verification take?
A: It typically takes **up to 48 hours** for your profile to be verified by your **Point of Contact (PoC)**.

Q: Can I book another resume slot with an expert to improve my resume further?
A: Yes, but only **after everyone in your set has completed their first session**. We prioritize students who haven't had a chance yet before allowing repeat slots.

Q: I missed enrolling in Set 1. What should I do?
A: That's absolutely fine! You can enroll in **Set 2**, which will open on **18th July**.

Q: Do I need to apply in all sets?
A: No, you only need to enroll in **any one set**. Once you do that, you'll receive access to the **resume slot sheet** for expert review.

Q: I'm unable to apply for the dummy placement cycle. What could be the issue?
A: Please ensure the following:

1. You are **enrolled in the placement cycle**
2. You are part of the **Passout Batch 2026**
3. Your **profile is verified** on Superset

Q: I have verified my profile. Can I still add things to Superset later?
A:Yes. You can add more details like new internships, certifications, etc., even after verification. However, every new addition will require fresh verification with proper PDF proof.

Q: I'm not able to enrol in the Dummy Placement Cycle. What should I do?
A: Please follow these steps:

Step A: Ensure profile verification:
• Edit all details and attach PDF proof
• Using this, submit your profile for verification: How to get your profile verified.pdf
Submit request via [Duperset]:
https://www.instagram.com/p/DLFhJ3SB_PX/?igsh=aHNvZjhuOGJyYThj
OR
Submit request via [Website]: https://ashokaplacecom.github.io/verify.html

Step B: The education section must reflect:
• '2026 Passout Batch' under Batch
• Course End Date: May 2026
• (4 Year) written in the degree (only for UGs)

If not editable, post on the PlaceCom Chatroom / Cohort Chatroom with your **enrolment ID** and your issue.

Step C: Once the above are done, go to Basic Details on Superset and enroll in 'Dummy Placement Cycle 2025-26'.

Q: My verification was approved, but it still shows pending. What should I do?
A: Resubmit the verification request via Duperset or the website. If it still doesn't update after 48 hours, post on the PlaceCom Chatroom with your **Enrollment ID.**

Q: How do I get in touch with my PoC?
A: The PoC system is anonymous. You cannot contact them directly. Instead:
• Submit verification using Duperset or the website.
• If you need help, post on the Chatroom or email Connect Placecom.

Q: What proof is accepted for clubs and societies?
A: Any one of the following:
- Certificate or letter of appointment
- Screenshot of official email
- Screenshot from official club social media
- WhatsApp group screenshot (if created by official authority)

Upload as a PDF on Superset.

Q: I'm not receiving an OTP on the verification website. What should I do?
A: Try incognito mode or switch to the Duperset extension. If still unresolved, email Connect Placecom or post in the chatroom.

Q: Can third-year students (5th semester) sit for placements?
A: No. As per the updated policy, 5th-semester students in 4-year UG programmes cannot sit for placements. Email the CDO and cc Connect Placecom if you'd like to discuss.

Q: Where can I find the CPP session calendar?
A: Refer to this link: CPP Schedule 2025–26 → CPP Calendar_2025-26.xlsx

Q: What if I can't enter my 7th semester CGPA?
A: Ensure your course shows:
- 2026 Batch
- May 2026 End Date
- (4-Year) Degree

Still stuck? Post your enrolment ID on the chatroom.
You can also refer to this instructional video: Adding 7th Sem.mp4

Q: How can I see companies that came last year?
A: Check the **Past Recruiters** section in the MasterDrive (link in the group description). Phase-wise data is listed there.

Q: What to do if my resume was wrongly rejected for personal pronouns?
A: Recheck for "I", "my", "we" and remove if missed. Then resubmit your one-page resume via Superset. Refer to the official PlaceCom_Resume Guidelines.pdf for clarity.

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